Employment Basics

Grundlagen des Arbeitsverhältnisses – Employment Basics

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Applies to	All employees of Norvane Systems GmbH at all sites, and all managers who take part in hiring
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1 Purpose and scope

In this policy we explain our employee contract types and define our basic employment policies. After the welcome and the introduction to our mission in the Employee Handbook (NS-HR-POL-005, section 2), it explains the basic aspects of employment: how we define full-time employment, how we hire, and what we expect regarding attendance. Your individual employment contract (Arbeitsvertrag) always takes precedence over this policy.

2 Employment contract types

2.1 Definitions

Full-time employees work 40 hours per week on average. Part-time employees work fewer than 40 hours per week, as agreed in their contract. Full-time and part-time employees can have either a fixed-term (befristet) or an open-ended (unbefristet) contract. Fixed-term contracts are agreed only where the law allows it, in line with the Part-Time and Fixed-Term Employment Act (Teilzeit- und Befristungsgesetz, TzBfG), and the reason or term is stated in the contract. Employment is not "at will": the termination rules in NS-HR-POL-006 and German law apply.

2.2 Overview

Type	Description	Notes
Full-time	40 hours per week	Standard contract; probation 6 months
Part-time	Fewer than 40 hours per week, as agreed in the contract	Vacation and benefits are calculated pro rata where the law allows
Fixed-term (befristet)	Employment for a defined period or project	Reason or maximum term as required by law; stated in the contract
Working student (Werkstudent)	Student employed alongside university studies	Usually up to 20 hours per week during term; mainly Engineering and IT Operations
Intern (Praktikant)	Internship of up to 6 months, mandatory or voluntary	Internship agreement; supervised by a named mentor
Apprentice (Auszubildende)	Dual vocational training in IT specialist roles	Training plan agreed with the vocational school and the Chamber of Commerce (IHK)
External contractor	Freelancers and service providers	Not employees; engaged by Procurement (Ingrid Larsen) under a service agreement; not covered by this policy

2.3 Benefits and equal treatment

All employees, regardless of contract type, receive the benefits described in NS-HR-POL-007, pro rata where a benefit can be measured by working time. Part-time and fixed-term employees are not treated less favourably than comparable full-time and open-ended employees without an objective reason. Some benefits are available only after the 6-month probation period; the policy for each benefit states this.

2.4 Key terms

Item	Rule
Contract	Issued in writing before the start date; the essential terms are stated in line with the Verification Act (Nachweisgesetz)
Probation (Probezeit)	6 months; notice period 2 weeks
Notice after probation	3 months to the end of a calendar month (see NS-HR-POL-006)
Working time	40 hours per week; flexitime and shift models as in NS-HR-POL-002
Personnel number	Employee ID starting with NS-10 (for example NS-10142), issued by HR at the start

3 Equal opportunity

3.1 Our commitment

Norvane Systems is an equal opportunity employer. We do not tolerate discrimination on grounds of race or ethnic origin, nationality, gender, religion or belief, disability, age or sexual identity, in line with the General Equal Treatment Act (Allgemeines Gleichbehandlungsgesetz, AGG). We want all employees, including executives and HR, to treat others with respect and professionalism. In practice, this means that we:

Commitment	How we do it
Hire and promote on skills, experience and potential	Structured interviews with the same questions for all candidates in a role, and at least two interviewers; bias awareness in every process
Make accommodations for people with disabilities	Barrier-free access at our sites, adjusted workplaces, assistive technology on request; HR advises on support for severely disabled employees
Use inclusive language	Job ads, signs and official documents use inclusive, diversity-sensitive language; job ads are open to all genders
Train our people	Diversity and communication training for all managers within 12 months of appointment, and for all employees on a voluntary basis

3.2 Reporting and protection

Apart from these actions, we commit to acting against every discriminatory, offensive or inappropriate behaviour. Please report any discriminatory action against yourself or your colleagues. Our company does not retaliate against you if you file a complaint, and any employee who retaliates or discriminates faces disciplinary action (NS-HR-POL-006).

Channel	Contact	Notes
Complaints Office (Beschwerdestelle) at HR	hr@norvane.example, ext. 2000	The formal channel under the AGG
Confidential ethics hotline	ethics@norvane.example, ext. 2650	Dr. Nadia Petrov; also for anonymous concerns
Works Council (Betriebsrat)	betriebsrat@norvane.example, ext. 2500	Thomas Bauer
EAP	eap@norvane.example, ext. 2010	Mariam Haddad; confidential support

4 Recruitment and selection

4.1 Principles

Our hiring steps may vary across roles, but we always aim for a fair and effective recruitment and selection process that hires great people. If you are hiring for an open role, you will likely go through the steps below. Steps may overlap, and you may skip steps where appropriate. Each member of the hiring team has different responsibilities: for example, recruiters source candidates, and hiring managers interview them. Recruiting runs in Personio, our applicant tracking system.

4.2 Process

Phase	Step	Responsible
Planning	1 Identify the need for a new job opening and get approved headcount	Hiring manager, department head
Planning	2 Decide whether to hire externally or internally	Hiring manager, HR
Planning	3 Review job description and write the job ad	Hiring manager, HR (Jordan Ellis)
Planning	4 Approval of the job ad	Department head, HR
Sourcing	5 Select sources: internal posting on the intranet for 5 working days, our careers page, job boards, universities, referrals	HR
Sourcing	6 Decide on hiring stages and timeframes	Hiring manager, HR
Sourcing	7 Review applications in Personio and approach passive candidates	HR
Selection	8 Shortlist applicants	Hiring manager, HR
Selection	9 Screen and interview candidates (phone screen, then two interviews)	HR, hiring manager, team
Selection	10 Check references (only with the candidate's consent) and, where legally justified, pre-employment checks (section 4.5)	HR

Phase	Step	Responsible
Selection	11 Select the most suitable candidate	Hiring team
Closing	12 Works Council hearing and consent (section 4.3)	HR Director
Closing	13 Official offer and contract	HR Director, Managing Director

4.3 Works Council

Before every hire (Einstellung), HR informs the Works Council (Betriebsrat) of the planned hiring and asks for its consent under the Works Constitution Act (BetrVG). The Works Council may also request that open positions are advertised internally first. The offer is only made after the Works Council has responded or the legal period of one week has expired.

4.4 Candidate experience and data protection

Throughout the process, we keep candidates informed, communicate well with each other and give everyone an equal opportunity to work with us. We confirm every application within 5 working days and give feedback within 10 working days after each interview. Ask HR for help whenever you need to improve the candidate experience or to write an inclusive job description. Application data are processed under the GDPR/DSGVO and NS-LEG-POL-001 and are deleted 6 months after a rejection, unless the candidate agrees to stay in our talent pool.

4.5 Background checks and pre-employment checks

This process is sensitive, and we must always abide by the law and make sure candidates understand our intentions. If you think a check is needed for a role, ask HR for guidance. In Germany, such checks are allowed only to a limited extent, so we apply these rules:

- We do not use external background-check providers or screen candidates' private social media.
- A certificate of good conduct (Führungszeugnis) can be requested from finalists only for roles where it is legally justified or required by a customer contract, for example roles with access to customer vaults or privileged access to customer environments. It is never requested before the offer stage.
- HR, not the hiring manager, views the certificate, records only that it was checked, and does not keep a copy. Dr. Nadia Petrov approves the check for each role.
- References from previous employers are requested only with the candidate's written consent.

5 Employee referrals

If you know someone who you think would be a good fit for a position at our company, please refer them. If we hire your referred candidate, you are eligible for a referral bonus.

Role	Referral bonus	Payment
Standard roles	EUR 1,500	With the payroll after the new colleague has passed the 6-month probation
Priority roles on the quarterly list published by HR, for example cloud security and senior DevOps roles	EUR 3,000	With the payroll after the new colleague has passed the 6-month probation

Additional rules for rewards:

- Rewards are paid with the salary of the month after the probation ends.

- There is no cap on the number of referrals an employee can make. All rewards are paid accordingly.
- If two or more employees refer the same candidate, only the first referrer, by the date of the referral in Personio, receives the bonus.
- Referrers are still eligible if the candidate is hired later or for another position, within 12 months of the referral.
- Referral bonuses are not paid for roles in HR, for recruiters, or for your own line reports.
- The bonus is part of your taxable income and is paid through payroll, with the usual deductions.

5.1 Who can be referred?

We have two conditions for candidates who qualify you for a reward. They must:

- Not have applied to Norvane Systems in the last 12 months.
- Be hired as permanent (open-ended) full-time or part-time employees, and not as fixed-term employees, working students, interns or contractors.

5.2 How to refer

Submit your referral through the referral link in Personio before the candidate applies, or send it directly to HR (Jordan Ellis). Only pass on a person's details with their consent, as required by data protection law. We encourage you to check our open positions on the intranet and to consider your social networks and external networks as sources of referrals.

6 Attendance

We expect you to be present during your scheduled working hours: on flexitime, that means during core hours (10:00-15:00) and on the on-site days agreed with your team, and in Garching during your shift. If you face an emergency that prevents you from coming to work, contact your line manager as soon as possible.

Situation	What to do	By when
Illness	Inform your line manager and hr@norvane.example; see NS-HR-POL-002 for the doctor's note	09:00 on the first day (Garching shifts: 30 minutes before the shift)
Emergency (for example accident, family emergency)	Call or message your line manager; if you cannot, ask someone to do it for you	As soon as possible
Planned absence	Request in Personio	As set out in NS-HR-POL-002
Late arrival or delay	Inform your team if you miss a meeting or core hours	Before the start of your day, if possible

We excuse unreported absences in cases of serious accidents and acute medical emergencies, where it was not possible for you to inform us. But whenever possible, we should know when you will not be coming in. Repeated or unexcused absence without notice may lead to a written warning (Abmahnung) under NS-HR-POL-006.

7 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
Recruiting, contracts, referrals	Jordan Ellis, HR Generalist	jordan.ellis@norvane.example	2020
Policy approval, offers	Julia Neumann, HR Director	julia.neumann@norvane.example	2001
General HR questions	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Complaints Office (Beschwerdestelle)	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Support in difficult situations	Mariam Haddad	eap@norvane.example	2010
Hiring consent, co-determination	Thomas Bauer, Works Council	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Background checks, applicant data	Dr. Nadia Petrov	privacy@norvane.example	2600
Ethics hotline	Dr. Nadia Petrov	ethics@norvane.example	2650
External contractors	Ingrid Larsen, Procurement Manager	ingrid.larsen@norvane.example	6000

8 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-HR-POL-001	Code of Conduct	Respect and professionalism
NS-HR-POL-002	Leave and Absence Policy	Working time and absence reporting
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies (v2.1, effective 01.01.2026)	Harassment and complaints
NS-HR-POL-005	Employee Handbook – Overview and Introduction	Section 2 summarises this policy
NS-HR-POL-006	Resignation and Termination Policy	Warnings and termination
NS-HR-POL-007	Employee Benefits and Perks	Benefits by contract type
NS-HR-POL-008	Employee Compensation and Development	Pay and probation review
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy	Applicant data

9 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	01.06.2023	Jordan Ellis	First issue
1.1	01.04.2024	Jordan Ellis	Added the employee referral programme
1.2	01.01.2026	Julia Neumann	Aligned with Employee Handbook v1.2
1.3	01.03.2026	Jordan Ellis	Added Works Council hiring consent, applicant data retention and priority roles list

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